

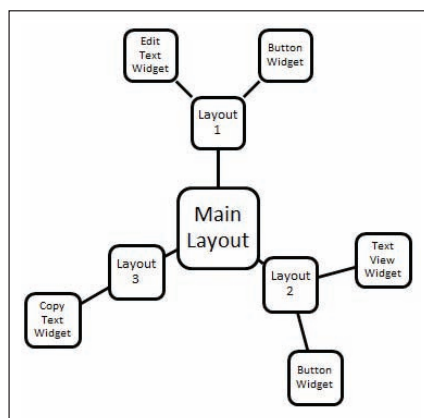
of a user with the widgets in the user interface. Though the developer adopts this approach, all the XML code is blown up into Java code by your ADT.

3.2 Views and layouts

Android user interface elements are organized into layouts and views. View comprises everything you see, such as a button, label or text box. Layouts organize views; it covers grouping buttons and labels or groups of such elements. Layouts are like Java containers and Views are like Java components. Views are sometimes referred to as widgets (These are the

views in the activities, and not the App Widgets embedded in the home screen application).

You can embed layout within another giving a parent-child hierarchy, which can further contain the widgets.



Layouts and Views relationship

3.2.1 LinearLayout

LinearLayout simply lays out its children horizontally or vertically next to each other. The order of the children in the layout matters, as in LinearLayout allocates space to each child in the order they are added. Hence,

if most of the space is allocated to an older child, there'll be very little left for subsequent widgets in this layout. However, nesting multiple LinearLayouts proves heavy for your memory resources and kills your battery life.

3.2.2 TableLayout

This layout places the children in a tabular form. It consists of only other TableRow widgets. TableRow represents a row in a table. These can also contain other UI widgets. TableRow widgets are like LinearLayout with horizontal orientation, as they are laid out next to each other horizontally. TableLayout is similar to <table> element in HTML and TableRow is like <tr>. However, a number of columns are defined dynamically based on the number of views added to a table row.